SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

11 November 2024 · Shift 2

77 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 13 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.2

In a stationary shop, a pen is marked as ₹80 and it is sold at a discount of 15%. The shopkeeper also offers a special discount of ₹8 on the pen. Find the cost price of the pen if the shopkeeper earns a profit of 20%.

(A) ₹60
(B) ₹75
(C) ₹62
(D) ₹50

Q.3

I walk at a speed of 10 km/h and reach my destination in 2 hrs. If I increase my speed by 2 km/h, how early would I reach my destination?

(A) 50 min
(B) 40 min
(C) 20 min
(D) 100 min

Q.4

Rahul and Rohit start running on a circular track (of length 360 m) from the same point simultaneously with a speed of 3 m/s and 4 m/s. After how much time from the start, they will meet again at the starting point?

(A) 12 minutes
(B) 2 minutes
(C) 6 minutes
(D) 3 minutes

Q.5

The sum of the radii of spheres A and B is 14 cm, the radius of A being larger than that of B. The difference between their surface areas is 112 π cm^2 . What is the ratio of the volumes of B to A?

(A) 64 : 27
(B) 25 : 64
(C) 64 : 25
(D) 27 : 64

Q.6

The HCF of 204 and 1547 is:

(A) 19
(B) 18
(C) 15
(D) 17

Q.8

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 5% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 290
(B) 250
(C) 190
(D) 210

Q.9

Manoj buys 1 kg tomato for ₹80 and sells it for ₹90. He also uses a weight of 800 gm in place of 1 kg. What is Manoj's actual profit percentage on the sale of 1 kg tomato?

(A) 37.5%
(B) 25%
(C) 12.5%
(D) 40.625%

Q.10

In a class of 40 students the ratio of boys to girls is 3 : 5. If the average marks scored by the boys in Science is 70 and the average marks scored by the whole class in Science is 60, then find the average marks scored by the girls in Science.

(A) 56
(B) 54
(C) 50
(D) 52

Q.12

₹7,000 becomes ₹7,567 in 2 years at simple interest at a certain rate percentage. Find the principal amount (in ₹) that will become ₹24,050 in 5 years at the same rate of interest.

(A) 24,000
(B) 20,000
(C) 12,500
(D) 18,300

Q.15

The average marks obtained by 75 students in a certain examination is 38. Find the total marks.

(A) 113
(B) 2850
(C) 1406
(D) 4294

Q.16

In an examination, the average marks obtained by 15 students was 96, by 12 other students was 84 and by 13 other students was 68. Find the average marks of all 40 students.

(A) 78.6
(B) 68.5
(C) 83.3
(D) 87.6

Q.17

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 69 kg and 36 kg is:

(A) 50
(B) 49
(C) 51
(D) 52

Q.18

Out of his monthly income, Mr. Sharma spends 24% on house rent and 70% on household expenses and saves the balance. If every month, he saves ₹1,200, then what is his monthly income?

(A) ₹25,000
(B) ₹20,000
(C) ₹27,000
(D) ₹32,000

Q.20

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 3% per year rate of interest for 3 years.

(A) 355
(B) 275
(C) 255
(D) 315

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 14 questions

Q.1

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order ? CEH, FHK, IKN, LNQ, ?

(A) PRU
(B) OQT
(C) MOP
(D) NPS

Q.2

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the following series? 12, 18, 36, 90, 252, ?

(A) 789
(B) 738
(C) 800
(D) 876

Q.5

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 15 ÷ 15 – 30 + 225 × 25 = ?

(A) 426
(B) 146
(C) 246
(D) 236

Q.6

This question has two statements followed by two conclusions numbered I and II. You have to take the given statements to be true even if they seem to be at variance from commonly known facts. You have to decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the given statements. Statements: All apricots are buns. All buns are sweet. Conclusions (I) Some apricots are sweet. (II) Some buns are apricots.

(A) Only conclusion (II) follows
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(C) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(D) Only conclusion (I) follows

Q.7

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (6, 24, 36) (8, 11, 25)

(A) (5, 19, 30)
(B) (15, 23, 34)
(C) (18, 2, 47)
(D) (2, 14, 20)

Q.9

Seven friends - M, N, O, P, Q, R, and S - are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). O is sitting third to the right of S. N is sitting second to the right of O. Q is an immediate neighbour of both M and S. P is an immediate neighbour of both O and N. Who is sitting to the immediate right of R?

(A) S
(B) M
(C) N
(D) O

Q.10

In a certain code language, 'EVIL' is coded as '5731' and 'BEAD' is coded as '4816'.What is the code for 'E' in the given code language?

(A) 3
(B) 5
(C) 1
(D) 8

Q.11

In a certain code language, ‘FEEDING’ is coded as ‘ECBDJPJ’ and ‘SURFACE’ is coded as ‘RSOFBEH’. How will ‘MIGRATE’ be coded in the same language?

(A) LGDRBVH
(B) LGERBVG
(C) LGCRCUI
(D) LHDRBUH

Q.12

In a certain code language, ‘GOAT’ is coded as ‘2684’ and ‘OPEN’ is coded as ‘3598’.What is the code for ‘O’ in the given code language?

(A) 3
(B) 8
(C) 6
(D) 5

Q.15

KRAV is related to GNWR in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, UBKF is related to QXGB. To which of the following is IPYT related, following the same logic?

(A) ELUP
(B) PELU
(C) ELPU
(D) LUPE

Q.17

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 111 – 1 + 36 ÷ 2 × 12 = ?

(A) 106
(B) 144
(C) 120
(D) 160

Q.18

Adesh, Rinki, Narendra, Priya, Kiara, Sahil, and Lakshmi are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Kiara sits third to the left of Sahil. Rinki sits to the immediate right of Priya, who sits with Sahil. Adesh sits second to the right of Lakshmi. Who is sitting to the immediate left of Adesh?

(A) Kiara
(B) Narendra
(C) Sahil
(D) Rinki

Q.19

12 is related to 139 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 17 is related to 284. To which ofthe following is 18 related, following the same logic?(NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbersinto its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /subtracting /multiplying etc. to 13can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 309
(B) 319
(C) 312
(D) 324

Q.20

FH 61 is related to JL 69 in a certain way. In the same way, QS 76 is related to UW 84. To which of the following is LN 46 related, following the same logic?

(A) NK 56
(B) CG 51
(C) PR 54
(D) HU 52

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1
Which of the following neighbouring countries of India is most populous?

(A) Pakistan
(B) Afghanistan
(C) Bhutan
(D) Bangladesh

Q.2
In the year 1940, the national games were hosted by which of the following cities?

(A) Patiala
(B) Lahore
(C) Lucknow
(D) Bombay

Q.3
The Mayurbhanj District in Odisha is a part of which Biosphere Reserve from the following?

(A) Pachmarhi
(B) Similipal
(C) Dehang Debang
(D) Nokrek

Q.4
In which of the following years was the state of Golconda finally annexed into the Mughal empire?

(A) 1697
(B) 1690
(C) 1685
(D) 1687

Q.5
Which of the following is/are the highest judiciary in India?

(A) High Courts
(B) District Courts
(C) Supreme Court
(D) Parliament

Q.6
Which of the following gases is generally used to flush bags of chips by the manufacturers?

(A) Nitrogen
(B) Carbon dioxide
(C) Compressed air
(D) Oxygen

Q.7
Who among the following was the founder of 'Satnami movement' in the central India?

(A) Saint Haridas
(B) Ghasidas
(C) Jyoti Rao Phule
(D) Narayan Guru

Q.8
In which of the following states is the groundnut fair, 'Kadalekayi Parishe' celebrated on the last Monday of the Karthika month of the Hindu calendar?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Kerala
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.9
The Great Granary was one of the largest granaries in the _____.

(A) Harappan Civilization
(B) Mesopotamian Civilization
(C) Mayan Civilization
(D) Egyptian Civilization

Q.10
As on February 2024, Nitish Kumar is the 9th time Chief Minister of which state?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Odisha
(C) Bihar
(D) Chattisgarh

Q.12

Forward Bloc was founded in 1939-40 by which of the following leaders?

(A) Subhash Chandra Bose
(B) Jawahar Lal Nehru
(C) Chittaranjan Das
(D) Rash Behari Bose

Q.13

Who among the following Indian dancers was honoured with the Padma Vibhushan in 1971, who was also known as the father of modern Indian dance?

(A) Pandit Durga Lal
(B) Kelucharan
(C) Uday Shankar
(D) Pandit Birju Maharaj

Q.14

As per Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, what is the total length of National Highways in India as of November 2022?

(A) 1,86,908 kilometres
(B) 1,45,897 kilometres
(C) 1,85,633 kilometres
(D) 1,44,634 kilometres

Q.15

What does a budget deficit indicate?

(A) Government spending exceeds government revenue
(B) The government is not allocating enough funds for public services
(C) The government is saving for future projects
(D) Government revenue exceeds government spending

Q.16

In December 2023, who became the first women Chief of Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) in India?

(A) Rashmi Shukla
(B) Nina Singh
(C) Vimla Mehra
(D) Archana Ramasundaram

Q.17

Which of the following is the federal feature of the Indian Constitution?

(A) Bicameralism
(B) All India Service
(C) Single Citizenship
(D) Integrated Judiciary

Q.18

The autobiography, 'An Autobiography' by Jawaharlal Nehru is also known as _____.

(A) The Accidental Prime Minister
(B) The Unfinished Innings
(C) Toward Freedom
(D) My Idea of Education

Q.19

In the 1974 edition of the Guinness Book of Records, which playback singer was mentioned as the most recorded artist in human history?

(A) Alka Yagnik
(B) KS Chithra
(C) Pulapaka Susheela
(D) Lata Mangeshkar

Q.20

The earthquakes that are generated due to the explosion of chemical or nuclear devices are known as:

(A) Collapse earthquakes
(B) Explosion earthquakes
(C) Tectonic earthquakes
(D) Reservoir-induced earthquakes

Q.21

Who among the following athletes was conferred with the Arjuna Award, 2021 by President Ram Nath Kovind?

(A) Tajinder Pal Singh Toor
(B) Arpinder Singh
(C) Swapna Barman
(D) Dutee Chand

Q.22

Dandiya Raas is a famous dance form of which state?

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Gujarat
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Punjab

Q.23

What is the female literacy rate in India, as per the 2011 census?

(A) 65.46%
(B) 66.44%
(C) 65.64%
(D) 64.66%

Q.24

When the body is deprived of energy from food, which of the following tissues is used to feed on its own?

(A) Epithelial tissue
(B) Collenchyma tissue
(C) Adipose tissue
(D) Nervous tissue

Q.25

Palkigundu Minor Rock Edicts of Ashoka are located in _____.

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Telangana
(C) Karnataka
(D) Tamil Nadu

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Based on the context of the given sentence, select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Siri was feeling _____ after receiving praise from her professor for completing the project ahead of schedule.

(A) in the same boat
(B) in the dark
(C) under the weather
(D) on top of the world

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Shyam approached an leading psychologist for his treatment of anxiety and depression.

(A) of anxiety and depression.
(B) for his treatment
(C) an leading psychologist
(D) Shyam approached

Q.3

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. My sister is allergic with peanuts, so be cautious when preparing her meal.

(A) so be cautious
(B) allergic with peanuts
(C) when preparing her meal.
(D) My sister is

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Our team lost the game / only because of / a mistake / with one of our players.

(A) only because of
(B) Our team lost the game
(C) with one of our players
(D) a mistake

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Ramgopal “is having” a very big house in Mumbai.

(A) has
(B) having
(C) have
(D) were having

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Her presentation was both informative and _____.

(A) entertaining
(B) entertain
(C) entertainer
(D) entertainingly

Q.7

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word. A) Occasion B) Privilege C) Bizzare D) Definitely

(A) B
(B) D
(C) C
(D) A

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Regal

(A) Majestic
(B) Modest
(C) Humble
(D) Ordinary

Q.9

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Exagerate
(B) Argument
(C) Misinterpret
(D) Unnecessary

Q.10

In the following sentence the underlined part contains as error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. They had a “least” celebration on her birthday.

(A) little
(B) less
(C) most less
(D) lesser

Q.11

Change the following sentence into positive degree. The dog is the most faithful animal.

(A) No other animal is as faithful as the dog.
(B) The dog is the only faithful animal.
(C) The dog is the faithful animal.
(D) The dog is more useful than any other animal.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate article to fill in the blank. Select 'no article' if no article is required. The doctor asked the patient to have _____ MRI scan of his brain.

(A) no article
(B) the
(C) a
(D) an

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word 'opacity' in the given sentence. The diminishing and deteriorating visibility in winter leads to the revival of accident cases on the highway.

(A) visibility
(B) deteriorating
(C) diminishing
(D) revival

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The poet had to “draw on his fancy” to write all his sonnets.

(A) use his money
(B) use his memory
(C) use his imagination
(D) use his clothes

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. A person who does not believe in the institution of marriage

(A) Misogamist
(B) Masochist
(C) Misogynist
(D) Nihilist

Q.16

Select the option that rectifies the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. She tried not to embarras her friend by bringing up the awkward incident at the party.

(A) emberrass
(B) embarass
(C) embarrass
(D) embarress

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word in brackets to fill in the blank. The mountain peak offers a breathtaking view, a striking contrast to the _____(peculiar) scenery below.

(A) ordinary
(B) beautiful
(C) abnormal
(D) odd

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word. The “board” will look into the matter.

(A) A member of a family
(B) A group of elected politicians
(C) A group of members of a company
(D) A union of workers

Q.19

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. My mother is 51 years old, / and my uncle is 48 years old. / So my mother is old than my uncle.

(A) and my uncle is 48 years old.
(B) So my mother is old than my uncle.
(C) My mother is 51 years old,
(D) No error

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. A lot of social work is “hindered” due to corrupt politicians.

(A) Collided
(B) Abided
(C) Helped
(D) Obstructed

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Speaking is a powerful tool (1)_____ human communication. It allows us to convey thoughts, emotions and ideas to others. Effective speaking (2)_____ not only the words we choose but also our tone, body language and overall presentation. Public speaking, in particular, can be (3)_____ a skill and an art, enabling individuals to inspire, educate and persuade audiences. (4)_____ it is a casual conversation with a friend or a formal presentation to a large group, the ability to express (5)_____ clearly and confidently through speaking is a valuable skill that can greatly impact our personal and professional lives.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) for
(B) at
(C) with
(D) on

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Speaking is a powerful tool (1)_____ human communication. It allows us to convey thoughts, emotions and ideas to others. Effective speaking (2)_____ not only the words we choose but also our tone, body language and overall presentation. Public speaking, in particular, can be (3)_____ a skill and an art, enabling individuals to inspire, educate and persuade audiences. (4)_____ it is a casual conversation with a friend or a formal presentation to a large group, the ability to express (5)_____ clearly and confidently through speaking is a valuable skill that can greatly impact our personal and professional lives.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) involving
(B) involved
(C) involve
(D) involves

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Speaking is a powerful tool (1)_____ human communication. It allows us to convey thoughts, emotions and ideas to others. Effective speaking (2)_____ not only the words we choose but also our tone, body language and overall presentation. Public speaking, in particular, can be (3)_____ a skill and an art, enabling individuals to inspire, educate and persuade audiences. (4)_____ it is a casual conversation with a friend or a formal presentation to a large group, the ability to express (5)_____ clearly and confidently through speaking is a valuable skill that can greatly impact our personal and professional lives.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) until
(B) both
(C) though
(D) and

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Speaking is a powerful tool (1)_____ human communication. It allows us to convey thoughts, emotions and ideas to others. Effective speaking (2)_____ not only the words we choose but also our tone, body language and overall presentation. Public speaking, in particular, can be (3)_____ a skill and an art, enabling individuals to inspire, educate and persuade audiences. (4)_____ it is a casual conversation with a friend or a formal presentation to a large group, the ability to express (5)_____ clearly and confidently through speaking is a valuable skill that can greatly impact our personal and professional lives.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Whereas
(B) Neither
(C) Whether
(D) Because

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Speaking is a powerful tool (1)_____ human communication. It allows us to convey thoughts, emotions and ideas to others. Effective speaking (2)_____ not only the words we choose but also our tone, body language and overall presentation. Public speaking, in particular, can be (3)_____ a skill and an art, enabling individuals to inspire, educate and persuade audiences. (4)_____ it is a casual conversation with a friend or a formal presentation to a large group, the ability to express (5)_____ clearly and confidently through speaking is a valuable skill that can greatly impact our personal and professional lives.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) herself
(B) itself
(C) ourselves
(D) themselves

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 · Answer (D) ₹50

₹80 less 15% is ₹68, and the special discount brings it to ₹60. A 20% profit means CP × 1.2 = ₹60, so CP = ₹50.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 20 min

The distance is 10 × 2 = 20 km. At 12 km/h it takes 20/12 hours = 1 hour 40 minutes: 20 minutes less.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 6 minutes

Rahul takes 360/3 = 120 s a lap and Rohit 360/4 = 90 s. They are next at the start together after LCM(120, 90) = 360 s = 6 minutes.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 27 : 64

$4\pi(R^2 - r^2) = 112\pi$, so $R^2 - r^2 = 28$; with R + r = 14, R – r = 2. So R = 8 and r = 6, and the volumes go as the cubes: $6^3 : 8^3 = 216 : 512 = 27 : 64$.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 17

$204 = 2^2 \times 3 \times 17$ and $1547 = 7 \times 13 \times 17$, so the HCF is 17.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 250

SI = 2,500 × 5 × 2/100 = ₹250.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 40.625%

For ₹90 he gives only 800 g, which cost him 0.8 × ₹80 = ₹64. Profit = 26/64 × 100 = 40.625%.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 54

There are 15 boys and 25 girls. The class total is 40 × 60 = 2,400 and the boys' 15 × 70 = 1,050, so the girls average 1,350/25 = 54.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 20,000

The interest for 2 years is ₹567, so the rate is 567/(7,000 × 2) × 100 = 4.05% a year. In 5 years the amount is P × 1.2025 = ₹24,050, so P = ₹20,000.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 2850

Total = 75 × 38 = 2,850.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 83.3

Total = 15 × 96 + 12 × 84 + 13 × 68 = 1,440 + 1,008 + 884 = 3,332, and 3,332/40 = 83.3.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 50

(40 + 49 + 56 + 69 + 36)/5 = 250/5 = 50 kg.

Q.18 · Answer (B) ₹20,000

He spends 24% + 70% = 94% and saves 6%: ₹1,200/0.06 = ₹20,000.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 315

SI = 3,500 × 3 × 3/100 = ₹315.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) OQT

Every letter moves 3 places forward each time: C, F, I, L, O; E, H, K, N, Q; H, K, N, Q, T. The next cluster is OQT.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 738

The differences 6, 18, 54, 162 are each three times the one before, so the next is 486: 252 + 486 = 738.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 246

After interchanging the signs: 15 × 15 + 30 – 225 ÷ 25 = 225 + 30 – 9 = 246.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
All apricots are buns and all buns are sweet, so all apricots are sweet, and some apricots are sweet (I). As all apricots are buns, some buns are apricots (II). Both follow.

Q.7 · Answer (A) (5, 19, 30)
In each set the third number is the sum of the first two plus 6: 6 + 24 + 6 = 36 and 8 + 11 + 6 = 25. Likewise 5 + 19 + 6 = 30.

Q.9 · Answer (A) S
Counting to the right of S: O is 3rd, N 5th and P, between them, 4th. Q sits next to S with M beside it, so Q is 1st and M 2nd (with Q 6th, M would need N's seat), leaving R 6th, just to the left of S. So S is to R's immediate right.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 1
E is the only letter in both words and 1 the only digit in both codes, so E = 1.

Q.11 · Answer (A) LGDRBVH
The letters move –1, –2, –3, 0, +1, +2, +3 in turn: FEEDING → ECBDJPJ and SURFACE → RSOFBEH. So MIGRATE → LGDRBVH.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 8
O is the only letter in both words and 8 the only digit in both codes, so O = 8.

Q.15 · Answer (A) ELUP
Each letter moves 4 places back (A wraps round to W): KRAV → GNWR and UBKF → QXGB. So IPYT → ELUP.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 106
After interchanging the signs: 111 + 1 – 36 × 2 ÷ 12 = 112 – 6 = 106.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Kiara
Counting to the right of Sahil: Kiara, third to his left, is 4th. Priya sits next to Sahil with Rinki on her right, so Priya is 1st and Rinki 2nd (on Sahil's left, Priya would put Rinki in Sahil's seat). Adesh, second to the right of Lakshmi, fits only as 5th with Lakshmi 3rd, so Kiara (4th) is to Adesh's immediate left.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 319
Each number is squared and 5 taken away: $12^2 – 5 = 139$ and $17^2 – 5 = 284$. So $18^2 – 5 = 319$.

Q.20 · Answer (C) PR 54
Each letter moves 4 places forward and the number rises by 8: FH 61 → JL 69 and QS 76 → UW 84. So LN 46 → PR 54.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Pakistan
Pakistan, with about 24 crore people by its 2023 census, is more populous than Bangladesh (about 17 crore); Afghanistan and Bhutan are far smaller.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Bombay
The 1940 edition, held in Bombay, was the first under the name National Games; until then the event was the Indian Olympic Games.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Similipal
The Similipal Biosphere Reserve lies in Odisha's Mayurbhanj district.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 1687
Aurangzeb took Golconda after a long siege in 1687 and annexed the Qutb Shahi kingdom to the Mughal empire.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Supreme Court
The Supreme Court is the highest court of India; Parliament is the legislature, not a court.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Nitrogen
Bags of chips are flushed with nitrogen, an unreactive gas, so that the oil in them is not oxidised and does not turn rancid.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Ghasidas
Guru Ghasidas founded the Satnami movement in the Chhattisgarh region in the early nineteenth century, preaching equality and rejecting caste.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Karnataka
Kadalekayi Parishe, the groundnut fair, is held at the Bull Temple in Basavanagudi, Bengaluru, Karnataka.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Harappan Civilization
The Great Granary is one of the largest buildings excavated at the cities of the Harappan Civilization.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Bihar
Nitish Kumar was sworn in as Chief Minister of Bihar for the ninth time on 28 January 2024.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Subhash Chandra Bose
Subhas Chandra Bose founded the All India Forward Bloc in 1939, after resigning as Congress president.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Uday Shankar
Uday Shankar, who blended Indian classical and folk forms with Western theatre, is called the father of modern Indian dance; he received the Padma Vibhushan in 1971.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 1,44,634 kilometres
SSC's key gives 1,44,634 km as the length of India's National Highways in November 2022, by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways' count.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Government spending exceeds government revenue
A budget deficit is the gap when a government's spending is more than its revenue.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Nina Singh
Nina Singh, an IPS officer of the Rajasthan cadre, became the first woman Director General of the CISF in December 2023.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Bicameralism
A bicameral legislature, with the Rajya Sabha representing the states, is a federal feature. All India Services, single citizenship and an integrated judiciary are unitary features.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Toward Freedom
Nehru's 'An Autobiography' (1936) was published in the United States as 'Toward Freedom'.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Lata Mangeshkar
The 1974 Guinness Book of Records named Lata Mangeshkar the most recorded artist in history.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Explosion earthquakes
NCERT calls the tremors caused by the explosion of chemical or nuclear devices explosion earthquakes.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Arpinder Singh
Triple jumper Arpinder Singh received the Arjuna Award 2021 from President Ram Nath Kovind in November 2021.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Gujarat
Dandiya Raas, danced with pairs of sticks, especially at Navratri, is a folk dance of Gujarat.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 65.46%
The 2011 census's provisional figures, the ones usually cited, put female literacy at 65.46% and male at 82.14% (74.04% overall).

Q.24 · Answer (C) Adipose tissue
Adipose tissue stores fat, which the body breaks down for energy when it gets too little from food.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Karnataka
The Palkigundu and Gavimath Minor Rock Edicts of Ashoka are near Koppal, in Karnataka.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) on top of the world
To be 'on top of the world' is to feel extremely happy, as Siri does after the praise.

Q.2 · Answer (C) an leading psychologist
'Leading' begins with a consonant sound, so it takes 'a': 'a leading psychologist'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) allergic with peanuts
One is allergic 'to' something: 'allergic to peanuts'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) with one of our players
A mistake made by someone is a mistake 'by' that person: 'a mistake by one of our players'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) has
'Have' meaning own describes a state, so it is not used in the continuous: 'Ramgopal has a very big house'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) entertaining
'Both … and' joins words of the same kind: two adjectives, 'informative and entertaining'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) C
The correct spelling is 'bizarre'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Majestic
'Regal' means fit for a king: 'majestic'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Exagerate
The correct spelling is 'exaggerate'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) little
A small celebration is 'a little celebration'; 'least' is a superlative and does not follow 'a'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) No other animal is as faithful as the dog.
The superlative 'the most faithful animal' becomes, in the positive degree, 'No other animal is as faithful as the dog.'

Q.12 · Answer (D) an
'MRI' is read 'em-ar-eye', beginning with a vowel sound, so it takes 'an'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) visibility
'Opacity' is the quality of not letting light through, of being hard to see through; its opposite is 'visibility'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) use his imagination
To 'draw on' something is to make use of it, and one's 'fancy' is one's imagination.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Misogamist
A misogamist dislikes or rejects marriage; a misogynist dislikes women and a masochist takes pleasure in his own pain.

Q.16 · Answer (C) embarrass
The correct spelling is 'embarrass', with a double 'r' and a double 's'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) ordinary
'Peculiar' means strange or unusual; its opposite is 'ordinary'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) A group of members of a company
A 'board' that looks into a matter is the group that runs a company or organisation, as in a board of directors.

Q.19 · Answer (B) So my mother is old than my uncle.
Comparing two people needs the comparative: 'older than my uncle'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Obstructed
'Hindered' means held back: 'obstructed'.

Q.21 · Answer (A) for
Speaking is a tool used 'for' human communication.

Q.22 · Answer (D) involves
The singular subject 'effective speaking' takes 'involves': it involves not only the words but also tone and presentation.

Q.23 · Answer (B) both
'Both a skill and an art': 'both … and' joins the two.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Whether
'Whether … or' sets out two possibilities: whether a casual conversation or a formal presentation.

Q.25 · Answer (C) ourselves
The passage speaks of 'our personal and professional lives', so the reflexive is 'ourselves': to express ourselves.

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